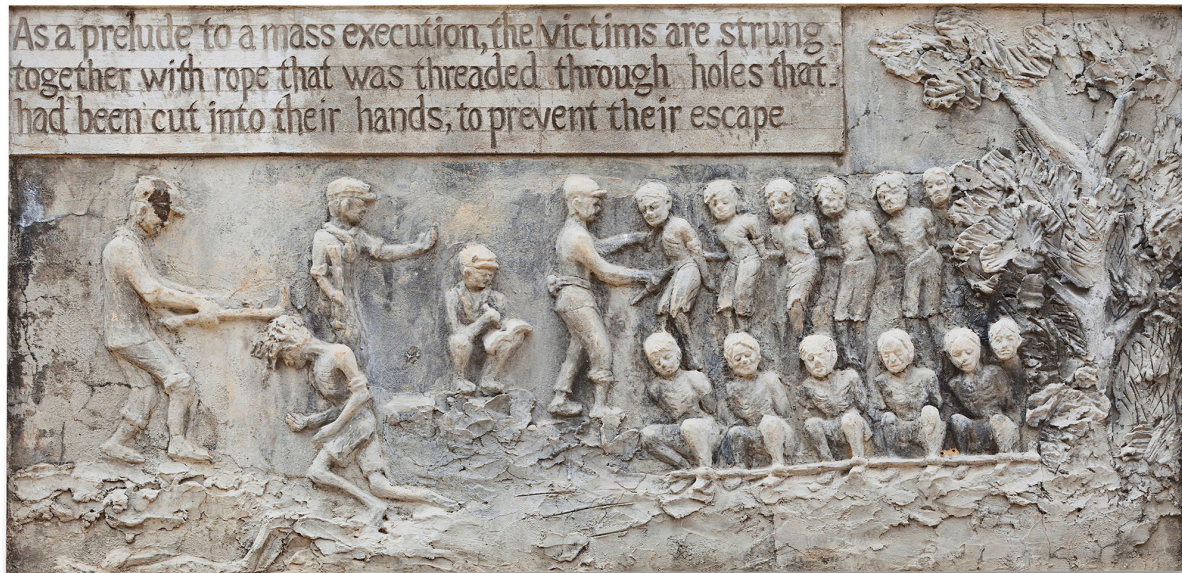




Never forgotten

This bas-relief at Wat Samrong Knong near Battambang, Cambodia, is one of a series of scenes detailing the atrocities committed by the Khmer Rouge. Here, victims are cruelly joined together en route to their mass execution.

Dismantling society

Pol Pot's assault on urbanity also included the repudiation of many institutions: hospitals and factories, but also foreign relations and financial structures. Money was abolished. Religion was outlawed, and communal living replaced single-family homes. The regime disrupted normal patterns of family life. Children were removed from their parents in order to be indoctrinated, while married couples were allowed to visit each other only on a limited basis. Those caught engaging in sexual activity could be executed on the spot.

The radicalism of Pol Pot was even more extreme than Mao Zedong's Cultural Revolution in China in the mid-1960s. However, like Mao, the Khmer Rouge soon realized that their regime would not survive without the restoration of the very institutions and skills they had sought to eradicate.